

TechNova Solutions Pvt. Ltd.

Employee HR Policy Handbook

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Human Resources Department

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This handbook outlines the official policies, entitlements, and guidelines governing employment at TechNova Solutions. All employees are expected to read and comply with the policies described in this document.

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Chapter 1: Company Overview

1.1 About TechNova Solutions

TechNova Solutions Pvt. Ltd. is a technology services company founded in 2015, headquartered in Bengaluru, Karnataka. The company specialises in software development, AI/ML consulting, and cloud infrastructure services. As of 2025, TechNova employs over 1,200 professionals across offices in Bengaluru, Pune, Hyderabad, and Chennai.

1.2 Mission and Values

TechNova's mission is to deliver innovative technology solutions that create measurable impact for clients. The company operates on five core values:

- Innovation — Encourage creative thinking and new ideas at every level.
- Integrity — Act honestly and transparently in all business dealings.
- Collaboration — Work as one team across functions and geographies.
- Excellence — Maintain the highest standards in all deliverables.
- Inclusion — Foster a diverse and respectful workplace for all employees.

1.3 Applicability of This Handbook

This handbook applies to all full-time employees, part-time employees, and contractual staff of TechNova Solutions. Policies marked as applicable to 'permanent employees only' do not apply to contract or intern staff unless explicitly stated. Interns are governed by a separate Internship Policy document.

Chapter 2: Employment Policies

2.1 Employment Types

TechNova recognises four categories of employment:

Employment Type	Probation Period	Notice Period	Benefits Eligible
Full-Time Permanent	6 months	60 days	Yes — full
Part-Time Permanent	3 months	30 days	Yes — partial
Fixed-Term Contract	None	30 days	Limited
Intern	None	7 days	Stipend only

2.2 Probation Policy

All new permanent employees undergo a probation period of six months from the date of joining. During probation, performance is reviewed at the three-month mark by the reporting manager. Employees who do not meet performance expectations may have their probation extended by up to three additional months. Confirmation of employment is communicated in writing by the HR department.

2.3 Background Verification

TechNova conducts mandatory background verification for all new hires. This includes education verification, previous employment verification, identity check, and criminal record check. Offers are conditional upon successful completion of background verification. Any discrepancy found may result in withdrawal of the offer or termination of employment.

2.4 Equal Opportunity Employment

TechNova is an equal opportunity employer. The company does not discriminate on the basis of caste, religion, gender, age, disability, marital status, sexual orientation, or place of origin. All hiring, promotion, and compensation decisions are based solely on merit and business requirements.

Chapter 3: Leave Policy

3.1 Leave Entitlements

All permanent employees are entitled to the following leave per calendar year. Leave is credited on January 1st each year. New joiners receive leave on a pro-rata basis depending on their date of joining.

Leave Type	Days Per Year	Carry Forward	Encashable
Earned Leave (EL)	18 days	Up to 30 days	Yes — at exit
Sick Leave (SL)	10 days	No	No
Casual Leave (CL)	8 days	No	No
Maternity Leave	26 weeks	No	No
Paternity Leave	10 days	No	No
Bereavement Leave	5 days	No	No
Marriage Leave	5 days (once)	No	No

3.2 Earned Leave (EL)

Earned Leave is accrued at 1.5 days per month of service. Employees may apply for EL for planned absences including vacations, personal commitments, or travel. EL must be applied at least 5 working days in advance and is subject to manager approval. A maximum of 30 accumulated EL days can be carried forward to the next calendar year. Any EL exceeding the carry-forward limit lapses.

3.3 Sick Leave (SL)

Sick Leave may be availed for personal illness or medical consultation. For absences exceeding 3 consecutive days, a medical certificate from a registered doctor must be submitted to HR within 2 working days of returning to work. Sick leave cannot be taken in advance and cannot be combined with casual leave for the same period of illness.

3.4 Maternity Leave

Female employees who have completed at least 80 days of service in the preceding 12 months are entitled to 26 weeks of paid maternity leave as per the Maternity Benefit (Amendment) Act, 2017. This leave can commence up to 8 weeks before the expected date of delivery. In case of miscarriage or medical termination of pregnancy, 6 weeks of paid leave is provided.

3.5 Leave Without Pay (LWP)

If an employee exhausts all entitled leaves and requires additional time off, they may apply for Leave Without Pay subject to manager and HR approval. LWP of more than 30 consecutive days may affect annual appraisal, increments, and benefit calculations for that year.

Note: Public holidays declared by the company are separate from leave entitlements and are published in the annual Holiday Calendar by December 31st of the preceding year.

Chapter 4: Salary and Compensation

4.1 Salary Structure

Employee compensation at TechNova is structured as a Cost to Company (CTC) package comprising the following components:

Component	% of CTC	Taxability
Basic Salary	40%	Fully taxable
House Rent Allowance (HRA)	20%	Partially exempt
Special Allowance	20%	Fully taxable
Provident Fund (Employer)	12% of Basic	Exempt
Performance Bonus	Up to 10%	Fully taxable
Gratuity	4.81% of Basic	Exempt at exit

4.2 Salary Disbursement

Salaries are credited to employee bank accounts on the last working day of each month. In case the last working day falls on a bank holiday, salary is credited on the preceding working day. Salary slips are available on the employee self-service portal (ESS) by the 2nd of the following month.

4.3 Performance Bonus

An annual performance bonus of up to 10% of CTC is awarded based on individual performance ratings and company profitability. Bonus is paid in April each year for the previous financial year. Employees who resign before March 31st of the appraisal year are not eligible for the bonus payout.

4.4 Provident Fund and Gratuity

TechNova contributes 12% of the Basic Salary towards the Employees' Provident Fund (EPF) as mandated by the Employees' Provident Funds Act, 1952. Employees contribute an equal 12% of Basic Salary. Gratuity is payable to employees who have completed a minimum of 5 years of continuous service, as per the Payment of Gratuity Act, 1972.

Chapter 5: Work Hours and Attendance

5.1 Standard Working Hours

The standard working week at TechNova is 45 hours, spread across 5 working days (Monday to Friday). Standard office hours are 9:00 AM to 6:00 PM with a one-hour lunch break. Employees in client-facing or shift-based roles may have different working hours as communicated by their manager.

5.2 Flexible Work Policy

TechNova offers a Flexi-Hours option for eligible employees (those who have completed 6 months of service and received at least a 'Meets Expectations' rating). Flexi-hours allow employees to choose start times between 8:00 AM and 10:00 AM, with end times adjusted accordingly. Core hours — 10:00 AM to 4:00 PM — are mandatory for all flexi-hour employees.

5.3 Work From Home Policy

Permanent employees are entitled to work from home up to 8 days per month, subject to manager approval and business requirements. WFH is not applicable during probation, client visits, or team events. Employees must be available on communication channels during standard working hours on WFH days.

5.4 Attendance and Late Arrivals

Attendance is marked through the biometric system or the HR mobile application. Employees who arrive more than 30 minutes late are marked as half-day absent unless prior approval has been taken. Three late arrivals in a month without prior approval will result in one Casual Leave being deducted automatically.

Chapter 6: Code of Conduct

6.1 Professional Behaviour

All employees are expected to maintain professional conduct at all times — in office, at client sites, during travel, and at company events. This includes respectful communication, meeting deadlines, maintaining confidentiality of company and client information, and dressing appropriately as per the workplace dress code.

6.2 Anti-Harassment Policy

TechNova has a zero-tolerance policy towards sexual harassment, bullying, and workplace discrimination. The company has constituted an Internal Complaints Committee (ICC) as per the Prevention, Prohibition and Redressal of Sexual Harassment (POSH) Act, 2013. Any employee who experiences or witnesses harassment must report it to the ICC or HR within 90 days of the incident.

6.3 Conflict of Interest

Employees must disclose any personal, financial, or professional interest that may conflict with TechNova's business interests. This includes employment or consulting for a competitor, financial interests in a supplier, or personal relationships with direct reports. Disclosures must be made in writing to HR and the employee's department head.

6.4 Confidentiality and Data Protection

Employees must not share, disclose, or misuse any proprietary, confidential, or client information — during or after their employment at TechNova. All employees sign a Non-Disclosure Agreement (NDA) on joining. Violation of confidentiality obligations may result in legal action in addition to disciplinary consequences.

Chapter 7: Performance and Appraisal

7.1 Performance Review Cycle

TechNova follows an annual performance review cycle from April to March. Mid-year reviews are conducted in October. The appraisal process includes self-assessment by the employee, assessment by the reporting manager, and a calibration discussion at the department level.

7.2 Performance Ratings

Rating	Description	Bonus Eligibility	Increment Range
5 — Outstanding	Significantly exceeds all goals	10% of CTC	15–20%
4 — Exceeds Expectations	Exceeds most goals	7.5% of CTC	10–15%
3 — Meets Expectations	Achieves all set goals	5% of CTC	6–10%
2 — Needs Improvement	Partially meets goals	None	0–5%
1 — Unsatisfactory	Does not meet goals	None	None

7.3 Increment Policy

Annual salary increments are effective from April 1st each year. Increments are communicated by March 31st through the employee self-service portal. Employees on probation, under a Performance Improvement Plan (PIP), or who have joined after January 1st of the current appraisal year receive increments on a pro-rata or deferred basis as decided by HR.

Chapter 8: Grievance and Disciplinary Policy

8.1 Grievance Redressal

Employees who have a workplace grievance — relating to working conditions, interpersonal conflicts, policy violations, or unfair treatment — should first raise it with their reporting manager. If unresolved within 5 working days, the grievance should be escalated to the HR Business Partner. All grievances will be acknowledged within 2 working days and resolved within 15 working days of formal submission.

8.2 Disciplinary Actions

Misconduct or policy violations are handled through a structured disciplinary process. Depending on the severity of the violation, the following actions may be taken:

- Verbal Warning — for minor, first-time violations.
- Written Warning — for repeated minor violations or moderate misconduct.
- Final Written Warning — for serious violations or repeated misconduct.
- Suspension — for severe violations pending investigation.
- Termination — for gross misconduct, fraud, harassment, or repeated final warnings.

All disciplinary actions are documented and placed in the employee's personnel file. Employees have the right to present their response before any action beyond a verbal warning is taken.

Chapter 9: Health and Benefits

9.1 Medical Insurance

TechNova provides group medical insurance to all permanent employees, covering the employee, spouse, and up to two dependent children. The sum insured is Rs. 5,00,000 per family per year. Employees may opt for an additional top-up cover of Rs. 5,00,000 at a subsidised premium paid by the employee. Insurance coverage begins on the date of joining.

9.2 Term Life Insurance

All permanent employees are covered under a group term life insurance policy with a sum assured of 3 times the annual CTC, subject to a minimum of Rs. 20,00,000 and a maximum of Rs. 1,00,00,000. The premium is fully borne by TechNova. Nominees must be registered in the HRMS system within 30 days of joining.

9.3 Employee Assistance Programme (EAP)

TechNova provides a confidential Employee Assistance Programme offering free counselling sessions for employees and their immediate family members. Up to 6 sessions per year are available with certified counsellors. The EAP covers mental health, financial stress, relationship issues, and career guidance. All sessions are strictly confidential and not reported to the company.

9.4 Other Benefits

- Internet Reimbursement: Rs. 1,000 per month for WFH-eligible employees.
- Mobile Allowance: Rs. 500 per month for employees in client-facing roles.
- Meal Card: Rs. 2,200 per month loaded on a prepaid meal card (tax-exempt).
- Learning Budget: Rs. 15,000 per year for approved courses, certifications, or books.
- Referral Bonus: Rs. 25,000 for successful employee referrals (paid after 3 months).

Chapter 10: Resignation and Exit Policy

10.1 Resignation Process

Employees wishing to resign must submit a formal resignation letter or email to their reporting manager and HR Business Partner. Resignations sent only via messaging apps or verbal communication are not accepted. The notice period begins from the date HR acknowledges the resignation in writing.

10.2 Notice Period

Employee Level	Notice Period Required
Junior (0–3 years experience)	30 days
Mid-Level (3–7 years experience)	60 days
Senior / Lead (7+ years experience)	90 days
Manager and Above	90 days
Probation Period	15 days

10.3 Notice Period Buy-Out

Employees may request a buy-out of the remaining notice period by paying the equivalent salary for the remaining days to TechNova. Alternatively, the company may waive the notice period at its discretion based on business requirements. Notice period waiver does not affect full and final settlement.

10.4 Full and Final Settlement

Full and final (F&F;) settlement is processed within 45 days of the last working day. The settlement includes payment of pending salary, earned leave encashment, gratuity (if applicable), and reimbursement of pending expenses. Any outstanding dues — including loans, advances, or asset recovery — are deducted from the F&F; settlement.

10.5 Exit Interview

All exiting employees are requested to participate in a confidential exit interview conducted by HR. The exit interview helps TechNova understand employee experience and improve workplace policies. Participation is voluntary but strongly encouraged. Feedback is aggregated and anonymised before being shared with leadership.

10.6 Rehire Policy

Former TechNova employees who left on good terms (no disciplinary record, completed notice period) are eligible for rehire after a minimum gap of 6 months. Rehires are treated as new joiners for all policy purposes except that their prior TechNova service may be considered for gratuity calculation if rehired within 5 years.

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